

PICTURE THE PLOT

If you've ever paused a film just to admire a single frame, Picture the Plot is where you turn that instinct into a challenge. You'll be handed a short film plot and one question: can you bring it to life without saying a word?

From decoding the story to hunting down the perfect people, props, locations, and unexpected details around campus, every shot becomes a piece of your narrative. But there's more — two twists will be thrown into the challenge along the way, forcing you to rethink, adapt, and get creative without losing sight of your original vision.

Once your frames are captured, it's time to turn them into a movie poster that feels like it belongs on a cinema wall. See like a director, frame like a photographer, and design like a storyteller. From the first clue to the final poster, every decision is yours — and every picture has a part to play.

How The Category Works

Plot Reveal (Day 1)

- You'll be handed a film plot—it could be a drama, thriller, comedy, sci-fi, or something completely unexpected.
- Dive into the plot, characters, settings, and key elements. Begin planning the shots, compositions, and overall aesthetic that will eventually form your final poster.

Photography Challenge (Day 1 - 2)

- Explore the campus and find the people, locations, objects, and moments that fit your assigned storyline.
- Experiment with wide shots, close-ups, portraits, unusual angles, shadows and silhouettes, textures and details, and different lighting conditions. You will be marked for your photography prowess!
- Capture a range of images, giving you plenty to work with later.
- **Plot Twist:** Each team will receive a mystery action or object on Day 2 that must be subtly incorporated into their poster. This should contribute to the story and remain naturally integrated into the scene.
- Participants must create a Drive folder named clearly with their group name, upload all raw photographs, and share the folder with the Category Heads by the specified deadline. Only the photographs submitted in this folder will be permitted for use in creating the poster on Day 3.
- Drive folder to be shared on the given email: mahnoornasir657@gmail.com

Important: You are not simply recreating the plot. Your photographs should communicate the story visually.

Poster Design (Day 3)

Maximum Delegates Allowed: 2

- Bring your selected photographs together and transform them into a polished movie poster.
- Arrange imagery, typography, colours, and other visual elements to reflect the atmosphere of your assigned storyline. Make thoughtful and visually engaging use of composition and spacing so that every element contributes to the overall concept and final design.
- During this round, teams may receive an unexpected Twist that must be incorporated into the finished poster.

- Participants will be given a fixed time limit to edit their photographs and create their posters. During this period, participants must remain within the designated room and will not be permitted to leave, in order to ensure fair play and prevent any unforeseen circumstances.
- In case participants need to leave the designated room, they are strictly forbidden from taking their gadgets with them. In case of an emergency, a Category Head will accompany the participant.
- Delegates must submit the final poster as a **PDF** to the Category Heads within the designated time limit. Late submissions will not be accepted.

Showcase (Day 4)

Maximum Delegates Allowed: 2

- Present your final creation to the judges, bringing your visual interpretation of the storyline to life.
- Be prepared to briefly explain the creative choices behind your work and how your team approached the challenges.
- Your submission will be evaluated on creativity, storytelling, visual execution, and how effectively the final poster captures the essence of your assigned plot.

Allowed Equipment:

- Camera (DSLR, mirrorless, or point-and-shoot)
- Mobile phones (for additional shots)
- Basic props and costumes (optional)
- Editing software (limited to Photoshop, Canva, Lightroom and basic photo-editing software)
- Personal phones, iPads and laptops for editing

All final visual material must originate from photographs captured by the participating team during the event.

Judging Criteria:

- **Creativity & Originality** (uniqueness of concept, imaginative interpretation and creative use of surroundings)
- **Storytelling & Plot Interpretation** (*how clearly the visuals communicate the characters, mood and narrative, A clear beginning/premise/conflict or story implication where appropriate*)
- **Photography & Visual Composition** (*framing, lighting, composition, focus, perspective and purposeful use of photographs*)
- **Poster Design, Cinematic Impact & Technical Execution** (*layout, typography, editing quality, attention to detail and use of original photographs, visual cohesion and overall movie-poster appeal*)
- **Plot Twist Integration** (*creative, natural and effective integration of both assigned twists*)
- **Final Presentation & Response** (*ability to briefly explain their concept, creative decisions and incorporation of the assigned twists, and respond to basic judge questions*)

Guidelines:

- **Original Content Only:** All photographs must be captured by the delegates during the event and within the campus. Stock, downloaded, AI-generated, or externally sourced content is strictly prohibited.
- **Raw Photo Verification:** All unedited original photographs used in the final poster must be submitted. The Category Heads will verify the raw photographs against the final poster. Any mismatch, use of photographs not submitted as raw files, or use of externally sourced material will result in immediate disqualification.
- **Editing Restrictions:** Editing must be completed by participating delegates only and strictly within the campus during the designated editing period. Delegates will not be allowed to leave the designated rooms with their devices. AI tools, AI-generated content, or editing assistance from any outside person is strictly prohibited.

- **Pre-Event Preparation:** All allowed editing software must be downloaded and installed before the event. Delegates are responsible for having reliable internet connectivity on their own devices.
- **Day-wise Requirements:** Days 1 and 2 are strictly dedicated to photography, including the incorporation of the assigned plot twists. Day 3 is strictly dedicated to editing and poster creation.
- **Location Restrictions:** Only campus areas accessible to all delegates may be used. All content must be created **ON CAMPUS**.
- **Prohibited Items:** No unsafe or inappropriate props, equipment, or content are permitted unless specified by the Category Heads.
- **Professional Conduct:** Delegates must not interfere with other teams, damage school property, or engage in inappropriate conduct.
- **Deadline Compliance:** Failure to submit the required final poster and photographs by the specified deadline will result in immediate disqualification. Late submissions will not be accepted.

Note:

- The proceedings of each round may be altered at the sole discretion of the category head.